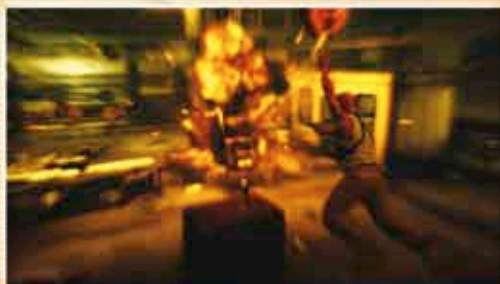


SKOAR!



MAX IS BACK!

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After eight years of agony, one of the most eagerly awaited games in recent times is just around the corner. Yes, Rockstar Games will finally launch Max Payne 3 next month. To commemorate the occasion, we take a closer look at some of the great things Max Payne 3 will introduce in the franchise, features that no doubt will be huge hits among Max Payne fans.

New engine

Max Payne 3 features cutting-edge advances to animation thanks to a new iteration to the game's RAGE engine. And with a close integration with Natural Motion's character behaviour system, thousands of animations work together to give any scene in Max Payne a realistic momentum and feel.

Upping the ante

The original game was at the forefront of technology back when it released, and Rockstar Games is only pushing the envelope of Max Payne 3's game features to make it relevant in 2012. Using brand new editing techniques, Max Payne 3 aims to blur the lines between cutscenes and gameplay, enabling seamless transition from one level to another with minimal load times.

Bullet time on steroids

A huge staple of Max Payne's legacy is Bullet Time. In Max Payne 3, Rockstar Games reveals that Bullet Time isn't just an important gameplay mechanic but the core approach to how the game is played, affecting pretty much everything in the game – from physics and animation to destructibility and particle effects.

Some upgrades to Bullet Time include Environmental Bullet Time, which showcases at least one epic scene per

level where Max performs incredibly stylish kills while using his surroundings to the fullest. Bullet cams of the original game are now Final Kill cams, which indicates the end of the last enemy in a wave or level. Players can speed up or slow down the velocity of each bullet in Final Kill cams, making for a true cinematic experience in Max Payne 3.

"These days, many games include some superficial form of slow-motion gameplay as one feature among many to mark off a checklist," says Jeronimo Barrera, VP Development, Rockstar Games. "But in the Max Payne series, bullet time is a core element of gameplay, both strategically and aesthetically," he adds.

Can't barely wait?

From all indications, Max Payne 3 looks like it's going to be awesome, with Bullet Time playing an integral role in the game. We can't wait for May 15 to come soon enough – meanwhile check this month's DVD for a whole host of Max Payne 3 trailers, screenshots and wallpapers. It's going to be epic! ✨

